



YOU ARE **39 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**
4 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Once labor starts, your baby will no longer have room to place their hands on top of their head or by their face, although, interestingly, they're still moving around—you probably won't notice these movements since you'll have other things on your mind.

“The inquiries may begin flooding in this week and it will feel as though the whole world is awaiting news of your baby's arrival.”

In this final week of your pregnancy, the weight of expectation can be immense. It can feel as though everyone is waiting for you to pop, especially if it's your first baby.

You'll no doubt cope with it this week—and you may even enjoy getting all the attention—but if you happen to go overdue, you might get frustrated by the constant calls and by having to repeat yourself. Try to be patient and remember people are simply excited for you and are just as frustrated with waiting as you are. Matters aren't helped by the due date. Everyone will have this estimated date in mind, but unfortunately not many babies stick to a schedule and they enter the world exactly when they are ready (see [The due date](#)).

By 42 weeks and beyond, fewer than 1 percent of women will still go into spontaneous labor.

ASK A DOCTOR

How much should my baby be moving?

Good fetal movements are the most important reassurance that your baby is doing well. You will notice a pattern to the movements; if this changes or you have concerns that the movements are different, contact your obstetrician and go for an immediate check. Your doctor will ask what has changed, monitor the baby's heartbeat, and may offer a cervical exam. If you've had two or more episodes of reduced movements in the last three weeks, they may perform an ultrasound to check the baby's amniotic fluid levels or recommend an induction; reduced movements may indicate a problem.

FALSE LABOR

You may experience deep and painful twinges, and practice contractions, known as Braxton-Hicks, particularly toward the end of pregnancy. It's easy to mistake these for the real thing, and